

6. Polymer gels are commonly used in disposable nappies.

A company that manufactures disposable nappies was investigating the effect of temperature on the mass of water the polymer gel in their nappies is able to absorb.

- (a) The results collected using water at 40 °C are given below. The initial mass of the polymer gel bead was 0.035 g.

Time (hours)	Mass of bead (g)	Mass of water absorbed by bead (g) (to 1 decimal place)
0	0.035	0.0
2	4.048	4.0
4	6.030	6.0
6	7.280	7.2
8	7.891	7.9
10	8.181	8.1
12	8.181	8.1

- (i) The percentage increase in the mass of the bead is calculated using the following equation.

percentage increase = $\frac{\text{mass of water absorbed}}{\text{initial mass of bead}} \times 100$

Calculate the percentage increase in the mass of the bead after 2 hours.
Give your answer to the nearest whole number.

[1]

Percentage increase = %

- (ii) What property of polymer gels does the figure calculated in part (i) demonstrate?

[1]

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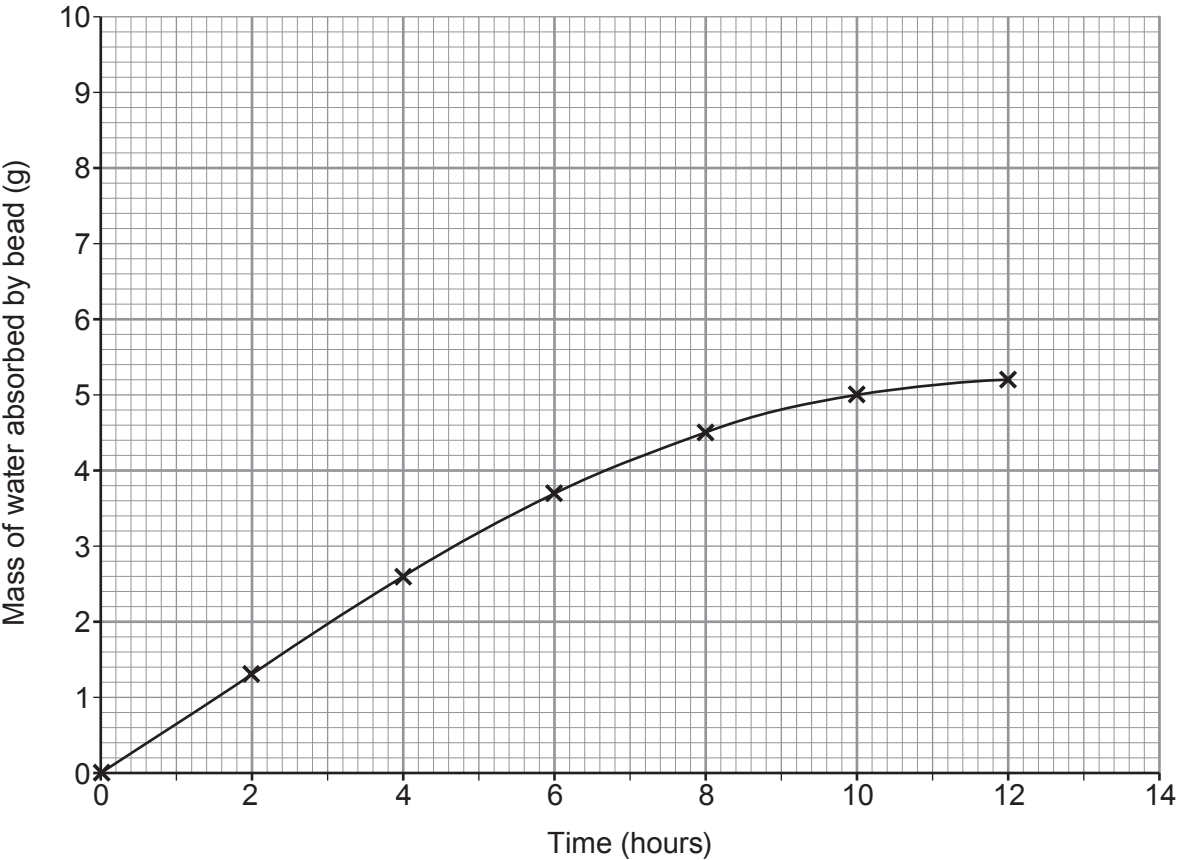


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- (b) (i) On the grid below, plot the results using water at 40 °C and draw a suitable line. Use the mass of water absorbed by the bead to 1 decimal place.

The results using water at 10 °C have already been plotted.

[3]



- (ii) Give **two** differences between the absorbing properties of the bead using water at 10 °C and at 40 °C.

[2]

Difference 1

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Difference 2

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7

